

Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting February 20th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QgU7W8-I_iU
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Muncie Development Commission (MRC) Meeting Report

Meeting Date: February 20, 2024

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order at [00:00:26](#), identifying it as the February 20th meeting of the Muncie Development Commission.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Bishop, Dale, Perella, Wagley, and Low.
 - **Absent:** Miller.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening remarks, but leading the proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None noted in the transcript.
- **Approval of Agenda:**
 - [00:00:40](#) Motion made and seconded to approve the agenda as presented. Approved by Voice Vote.

- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **00:01:13** January meeting memoranda reviewed. Board member noted missing informative information and stated opposition.
 - **00:01:30** A separate motion was made and seconded to approve the memoranda as submitted.
 - **Vote Disposition:** Passed 3-1 via roll call vote (Bishop: Yes, Dale: No, Perella: Yes, Wagley: Yes).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:54 Controller's Report & Claims Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig (Controller).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The controller presented claims and addressed questions regarding large infrastructure funds, explaining that funds (such as those from Markets on Madison and street paving approved the previous month) are being reallocated rather than immediately spent.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to approve claims as submitted. Passed 4-0 via roll call vote (Bishop: Yes, Dale: Yes, Perella: Yes, Wagley: Yes).
- **00:03:06 Report from the City / Department of Development**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Staff / Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *Financials:* Provided updates on TIF balances (Mall TIF at \$427k, Mad Jax TIF under \$10k, Central TIF at \$91k, South TIF at \$92k, Delaware Dynamics at \$110k, Mall parking lot at \$2k), White River Phase 2 public space/streets, Till Pond, park funds, total focus funds (over \$2 million), consolidated TIF, and other cash accounts. Estimated consolidated TIF balance projected near \$3.4 million by year-end.
 - *Housing & Development:* DR Horton closed on 9 lots with 6 to 9 homes under construction; title work set for another 9 lots. Construction ongoing at 5 Degrees. Active discussions underway with home builders for new developments and three hotel developers regarding downtown Muncie hotels. Significant private/public investment progress noted in "The Village" (\$185M estimated investment collaborative with Ball State).
 - *Housing Strategy & Community Projects:* Addressing the estimated shortage of over 2,000 affordable housing units and targeting commuters who currently work in Muncie but live elsewhere. Staff noted involvement in the Horizon Convention Center CEO search committee and the Creative Action Plan steering committee.

- *Board Discussion/Controversy:* Board members Dale and Bishop raised concerns regarding a previous month's vote on a \$1.6+ million spending package, specifically questioning a \$400,000 allocation for retiring bond debt on the Indiana stamping project. Staff clarified that legal counsel determined the agreement was held with the Muncie Community Development Corporation rather than the MRC, meaning MRC funds would not be expended for that purpose.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information report only; no formal board action required.
- **00:07:08 Muncie Land Bank Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard, Muncie Land Bank.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *Board Updates:* Noted three new mayoral board appointments and the departure of Jim low (replaced by John West).
 - *Acquisition & Disposition:* Out of 36 tax certificates, 7 have been transferred to Habitat for Humanity to support a \$1 million grant project. The remaining 26 have gone through the redemption process and are moving toward quiet title actions via public notification in the Star Press. Highlighted the successful rehabilitation of 612 West Fifth Street in partnership with PathStone and CDBG funds to create affordable housing.
 - *Partnerships & Outreach:* Working with neighborhood associations (Whitely, Industry, Old West End, 812 area). Upcoming "First Friday" (shifted to second Friday, March 14th) will feature Tim Corkran from South Bend discussing public-private housing partnerships. Mentioned upcoming presentations at the IDEA conference (March 8th) and hosting the Hancock Economic Development Council.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information report only; no formal board action required.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:17:10 / 00:27:12 <U+2014> Tanya Side** (New Executive Director, Muncie Arts / Muncie Arts and Culture Council)
 - Introduced herself to the board, noting she started her position on February 7th. Provided background on her 30 years in communications and museum/arts education (including previous roles at Minista Museum and Gardens, Ball State University Foundation, and David Owsley Museum of Art). Highlighted Muncie Arts' transition into a service organization, ongoing public art initiatives (painted traffic

boxes, artist residencies, mayor's arts awards), and the economic driver potential of arts and culture in the community.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None beyond reports delivered during regular agenda items.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - **00:27:41** Motion made and seconded to adjourn.
 - **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote; meeting adjourned.
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